

Word family: **junior / juniors / junior-level**

Base word: junior

Part of speech: **adjective** and **noun**

Related forms / useful extensions:

- * **junior** (adj.) — 年幼的；較低級的；初級的；資歷較淺的
- * **junior** (n.) — 年幼者；職級較低者；初級成員
- * **junior school / junior secondary school** — 初級學校 / 初中
- * **junior staff** — 初級員工；資歷較淺員工
- * **junior doctor** — 初級醫生 / 資歷較淺的醫生
- * **junior partner** — 初級合夥人
- * **junior member** — 年輕 / 低階成員
- * **junior to someone** — 資歷 / 職級低於某人
- * **X years someone's junior** — 比某人年輕 X 歲
- * **junior league / junior team** — 青少年組 / 青年隊
- * **Junior / Jr.** — 小.....；同名父子的較年輕者

Meaning in this passage

> I first met him when I was in **junior secondary school**.

Here, **junior** means:

belonging to the earlier/lower years of secondary education — 初級的；初中階段的

中文翻譯：

我第一次認識他是在**初中時期**。

So here:

junior secondary school = 初中

In a Hong Kong-style education context, this usually refers to the lower secondary years.

1. **junior secondary school — 初中**

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> I first met him when I was in **junior secondary school**.

我第一次認識他是在**初中時期**。

Practice 2

> Students in **junior secondary school** study a broad range of subjects.

初中學生會修讀多種科目。

Practice 3

> She taught science at a **junior secondary school**.

她在一間**初中**教授科學。

MCQ-ready definition:

junior secondary school = 中等教育較早期的年級 / 階段

2. **junior (較低年級 / 較低階段的) — 初級的 ; 低年級的**

Practice 1

> The programme is designed for **junior students**.

這個課程是為**較低年級學生**而設。

Practice 2

> He teaches the **junior classes**.

他教授**低年級班別**。

MCQ-ready definition:

junior = 處於較低年級、較早階段或較初級層次的

3. **junior staff / employee — 初級員工 ; 資歷較淺的人員**

A major workplace sense.

Practice 1

> She started as a **junior employee**.

她最初是一名**初級員工**。

Practice 2

> The company provides training for **junior staff**.

公司為**資歷較淺的員工**提供培訓。

MCQ-ready definition:

junior staff = 在職級、經驗或資歷上較低的人員

4. **junior position / role** — 初級職位

Practice 1

> He applied for a **junior position** in marketing.

他申請了一個市場部的**初級職位**。

Practice 2

> She joined the company in a **junior role**.

她以一個**初級職位**加入公司。

MCQ-ready definition:

junior position/role = 對經驗要求較低、職級較低的職位

5. **junior to someone** — 職級 / 資歷低於某人

Practice 1

> She is **junior to me** in the department.

她在部門內的**職級比我低**。

Practice 2

> He is several levels **junior to the director**.

他的**職級比總監低幾級**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****junior to someone = 在職級、資歷或地位上低於某人****

6. ****X years someone's junior — 比某人年輕 X 歲****

A fixed comparative structure.

Practice 1

> She is five years ****his junior****.

她比他****年輕五歲****。

Practice 2

> My brother is two years ****my junior****.

我弟弟比我****小兩歲****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****X years someone's junior = 比某人年輕 X 歲****

7. ****junior (年幼的 ; 較年輕的) — 年幼的 ; 較年輕的****

Practice 1

> The ****junior members**** of the family sat together.

家中****較年幼的成員****坐在一起。

Practice 2

> She competed in the ****junior category****.

她參加了****青少年組別****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****junior = 年齡較小、屬於較年輕組別的****

8. **junior team / junior league — 青少年隊 / 青年組別**

Practice 1

> He plays for the club's **junior team**.

他效力於球會的**青年隊**。

Practice 2

> She won the **junior championship**.

她贏得了**青少年組冠軍**。

MCQ-ready definition:

junior team/league = 供較年輕參賽者參加的隊伍或比賽組別

9. **junior member — 初級 / 年輕成員**

Depending on context, this can refer to age or rank.

Practice 1

> He is one of the **junior members** of the research team.

他是研究團隊中**資歷較淺的成員之一**。

Practice 2

> The club has activities for **junior members**.

這個會所有供**年輕會員**參加的活動。

MCQ-ready definition:

junior member = 年齡較小或職級 / 資歷較低的成員

10. **Junior / Jr. (同名父子的較年輕者) — 小.....**

A distinct naming use.

Practice 1

> His father is also called David, so he is David Smith **Junior**.

他的父親也叫 David，所以他是 **小 David Smith**。

Practice 2

> Robert Downey **Jr.** is an actor.

Robert Downey **Jr.** 是一名演員。

MCQ-ready definition:

Junior / Jr. = 用在與父親同名的兒子姓名後，表示較年輕的一代

11. **junior (noun : 年幼者 / 初級成員) — 年輕者；初級成員**

Practice 1

> The juniors trained separately from the seniors.

年輕組 / 初級組成員與高級組分開訓練。

Practice 2

> The competition includes both seniors and **juniors**.

比賽包括成人組和**青少年組**。

MCQ-ready definition:

junior = 年齡、職級或級別較低的人

12. **junior doctor — 初級醫生；資歷較淺醫生**

A professional title/category in some systems.

Practice 1

> She worked as a **junior doctor** after graduating.

她畢業後擔任**初級醫生**。

Practice 2

> The hospital provides supervision for **junior doctors**.

醫院為**資歷較淺的醫生**提供督導。

MCQ-ready definition:

junior doctor = 處於較早職業訓練或較低資歷階段的醫生

13. **junior partner** — 初級合夥人

Practice 1

> He became a **junior partner** at the firm.

他成為公司的**初級合夥人**。

Practice 2

> The **junior partner** had less authority than the senior partner.

初級合夥人的權力比高級合夥人少。

MCQ-ready definition:

junior partner = 在合夥制度中地位、資歷或權責較低的合夥人

Important distinction 1: **junior vs young**

young

simply means not old.

junior

usually compares age, rank, stage, or level.

> a young teacher

年輕老師

> a junior teacher

資歷較淺 / 職級較低的老師

So **junior** ≠ simply young.

Important distinction 2: **junior** vs **secondary**

secondary

refers to the entire secondary education stage.

junior secondary

refers to the earlier/lower part of secondary education.

So:

> secondary school = 中學

> junior secondary school = 初中

Important distinction 3: **junior** vs **senior**

This is the central contrast.

junior

younger / lower-ranked / earlier-stage

senior

older / higher-ranked / later-stage

Examples:

* junior staff ↔ senior staff

* junior team ↔ senior team

* junior secondary ↔ senior secondary

Important distinction 4: **junior** vs **beginner**

junior

usually refers to rank, age, or career stage.

****beginner****

means someone who has only just started learning an activity.

A junior engineer may already be skilled and not a beginner.

Important distinction 5: ****junior vs entry-level****

****entry-level****

specifically describes the lowest starting level in employment.

****junior****

broader and can mean relatively low-ranked, not necessarily absolute beginner.

> entry-level analyst

入門職位分析員

> junior analyst

初級分析員

They often overlap but are not identical.

Important distinction 6: ****junior to vs younger than****

****junior to someone****

often formal and can refer to rank/experience.

****younger than****

only refers to age.

> She is junior to me at work.

她在工作上的資歷比我低。

> She is younger than me.

她比我年輕。

Important distinction 7: **three years his junior vs three years younger than him**

These mean the same in age.

> She is three years **his junior**.

= She is three years **younger than him**.

The **junior** structure is more formal.

Important distinction 8: **junior member can be ambiguous**

> junior member

can mean:

1. younger member
2. lower-ranking / less experienced member

Context decides.

Important distinction 9: **Junior vs junior**

Capitalization matters.

Junior / Jr.

part of a person's name.

junior

ordinary adjective/noun.

> John Smith Jr.

VS

> a junior employee

Important distinction 10: **junior school terminology varies**

Education terms vary by country.

Junior school, **junior high**, **junior secondary**, and **middle school** are not globally identical.

For your Hong Kong-style passage:

junior secondary school = 初中

is the correct contextual interpretation.

Family-extension note

Junior has a compact but productive semantic structure built around:

being lower/earlier/younger relative to another level

Its main branches are:

1. **education stage**

- * junior secondary school
- * junior classes

2. **workplace rank**

- * junior staff
- * junior role
- * junior partner

3. **relative rank**

- * junior to someone

4. **relative age**

* five years his junior

5. **youth category**

* junior team

* junior championship

6. **name suffix**

* Junior / Jr.

These are strongly connected, but learners need to distinguish **age**, **rank**, and **education stage** carefully.

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea	
-----	-----	-----	
junior secondary school	初中	earlier secondary stage	
junior class/student	低年級班 / 學生	lower level	
junior staff	初級員工	lower rank	
junior position	初級職位	lower career level	
junior to someone	職級 / 資歷低於某人	relative rank	
five years his junior	比他年輕五歲	relative age	
junior category	青少年組	younger age group	
junior team	青年隊	younger team	
junior member	年輕 / 初級成員	younger or lower-ranked	
junior doctor	初級醫生	early career stage	
junior partner	初級合夥人	lower partnership rank	
Junior / Jr.	小.....	younger same-name generation	
a junior	年輕者 / 初級成員	lower/younger person	

For your original sentence

> I first met him when I was in **junior secondary school**.

Here:

junior = 較低年級的 ; 初級階段的

and the whole expression:

junior secondary school = 初中

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 我第一次認識他是在**初中時期**。

So the exact passage sense is the **earlier/lower stage of secondary education**, not the workplace sense of **junior = 資歷較淺**, nor the age-comparison sense **X years someone's junior**.